Ethical and Transformational Leadership

Quick briefing

Apply the three ethical lenses to a decision under pressure and recognize the Four I's of transformational leadership.

Know the facts

Ethical leadership and integrity · Base choices on the Army Ethic and Values and keep actions consistent with stated standards, especially under pressure.

Three ethical lenses · Rules-based reasoning checks duties and constraints. Outcomes-based reasoning weighs effects. Virtue-based reasoning asks what conduct reflects Army Values and character.

Operational legitimacy · Lawful and ethical conduct supports confidence in the unit and the legitimacy of its actions.

Transactional leadership · Uses clear expectations, contingent rewards, and corrective action to manage performance.

The Four I's · Idealized influence models standards. Inspirational motivation gives shared purpose. Intellectual stimulation encourages better ideas. Individualized consideration tailors development.

Understand the reasoning

Check applicable rules before weighing convenience. A choice can save time and still produce a misleading report or violate a duty.

Correcting one lapse sets a standard. Modeling candor and inviting the team to improve its checking process can also change what people do under the next deadline.

Philippine Army classroom exercise

Before a Philippine Army class demonstration, a team leader learns that a required equipment check was skipped. The group has already described its preparations as complete, and the schedule has little slack.

Decision · How should the leader act now, and how could the leader reduce pressure to conceal the next problem?

Worked analysis · Update the instructor with the actual status and complete the check before using the equipment. If needed, present an approved substitute or revise the demonstration schedule. Own the reporting error openly and ask the group to redesign how it records completed checks. Accuracy protects the next decision, and the follow-up gives the team a way to improve.

How to practice

1 · Define the dilemma and identify the duties or values in tension.

2 · Identify applicable rules, orders, and Army Values.

3 · Develop feasible courses of action.

4 · Evaluate each option through rules, outcomes, and virtues.

5 · Choose, act, and take responsibility for the decision.

6 · Reflect on the outcome and identify a lesson for future decisions.

Check yourself

Which ethical lens asks how a choice affects the mission, soldiers, and unit? · The outcomes-based lens.

Which of the Four I's invites people to challenge assumptions and propose improvements? · Intellectual stimulation.

Course source

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